

What Is a User Authentication Policy?



A user authentication policy is a process in which you verify that someone who is attempting to access services and applications is who they claim to be. This can be accomplished through a variety of authentication methods, such as entering a password into your laptop or phone or a PIN number into the ATM.

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What are the different authentication protocols?

Network authentication protocols are used to help securely transfer identity credentials for authentication between the subject (user or device) and the authentication server. There are several different authentication protocols for network access control, including:

- Kerberos
- Extensible Authentication Protocol (EAP)
- IEEE 802.1X
- Remote Authentication Dial-In User Service (RADIUS)
- Terminal Access Controller Access-Control System (TACACS)

Learn more about **authentication protocol technologies**.

How do I benefit from a user authentication policy?

A user authentication policy may be used to help ensure that only the intended audience is accessing certain assets in your organization. User authentication policies strive to ensure that the person requesting sensitive information and data is the right person to access that information.

Types of user authentication

Two-factor authentication (2FA)

Two-factor authentication, a subset of multi-factor authentication (MFA), is a two-step authentication process. It combines a username and password, or PIN, with a physical or mobile token for extra security. This combination of authentication factors makes it more difficult for a potential intruder to gain access.

Three-factor authentication (3FA)

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Four-factor authentication (4FA)

Four-factor identification is another form of layered security that involves knowledge, possession, inherence, and location. As with 3FA, knowledge, possession, and inherence consist of passwords and PINs, token authentication, and biometrics. For an extra layer of security, 4FA also uses verification of a user's login to authenticate the user.

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